

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 723

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor Tennessean Jack White upon The White Stripes being inducted into the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a Tennessean who, as a result of his trailblazing work in returning rock music to the raw power of its origins, has joined the greatest artists in the music industry as a member of the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, The White Stripes, a dynamic duo founded by Jack White and Meg White, was inducted into the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame in 2025 by the legendary Iggy Pop; and

WHEREAS, on this auspicious occasion, the Hall praised the White Stripes for "reinvigorat[ing] rock & roll by returning it to its primal blues roots, proving that a duo with defiant energy, catchy riffs, melodic savvy and unique style could captivate as much, if not more, than a large, complex ensemble"; and

WHEREAS, composed of mastermind multi-instrumentalist and vocalist Jack White and Meg White, a minimalist, yet hypnotic, drummer, The White Stripes emerged from Detroit in 1997 and became one of the leading bands of the early 2000s' indie and garage-rock revival; and

WHEREAS, the band's raw, simple approach to composing, arranging, and performing music created a low-fidelity, stripped-down sound that proved greater than the sum of its parts; and

WHEREAS, inspired by the garage rock of The Stooges and MC5 and blues artists such as Son House and Blind Willie McTell, The White Stripes have influenced a diverse array of present-day artists, including Beyoncé, Olivia Rodrigo, and St. Vincent; and

WHEREAS, The White Stripes's first two albums established the band with music critics and knowledgeable rock fans, but their third album, *White Blood Cells*, catapulted the duo to a new level, and they soon became one of the most acclaimed bands of the early 2000s; and

WHEREAS, named one of the top-ten albums of its era, *White Blood Cells* earned the band its first gold record, and its signature driving sound, as personified by "Fell in Love with a Girl," attracted new fans from around the globe; and

WHEREAS, The White Stripes's next album, *Elephant*, received even greater critical acclaim and won the 2004 Grammy for Best Alternative Music Album; the platinum-selling album is generally considered the pinnacle of the band's oeuvre and one of Jack White's greatest works; and

WHEREAS, included on this triumphant album is the genre-defying anthem "Seven Nation Army," which won the Grammy for Best Rock Song and is now ubiquitous both in the media and at sporting events; and

WHEREAS, the Grammy-winning *Get Behind Me Satan*, a more experimental album released in 2005, set aside The White Stripes's primitive, propulsive sound in favor of expanded arrangements, studio overdubbing, country-folk influences, and piano-driven songs, including "My Doorbell"; and

WHEREAS, The White Stripes concluded their decade of musical excellence with 2007's *Icky Thump*, which marked a return to their rock and blues influences and produced their first top-forty hit with the title song; and

WHEREAS, their sixth album, *Icky Thump* also won the Grammy for Best Alternative Music Album, bringing the band's total to eleven Grammy nominations and six Grammy wins; and

WHEREAS, after a grueling decade-plus of extensive recording and touring, The White Stripes officially parted ways in 2011, leaving behind a legacy of musical innovation through simplicity; and

WHEREAS, since the dissolution of the band, Jack White has continued to make essential music, first as a member of The Raconteurs and then as a solo artist; he has six solo albums and six additional Grammys to his credit, and his 2025 world tour featured sold-out shows in the United States, Denmark, Norway, Sweden, South Korea, the United Kingdom, and eight additional countries; and

WHEREAS, touted as "the coolest, weirdest, and savviest rock star of our time," Jack White is also a proud Tennessean, and the Nashville store of his Third Man Records label is one of only three such facilities in the world; and

WHEREAS, Jack White is most deserving of our approbation on the momentous occasion of his induction into the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Tennessean Jack White upon The White Stripes being inducted into the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame, recognize his many contributions to popular music, and wish him all the best in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.